

New Ground: A Missing Voice

新的起点：缺席的声音

Theme: 大学生生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

A group of **folk** who worked the evening shift **often** passed the club room without stopping. **Obviously** they had something to say, and **neither** Lin nor Maya had asked them. Maya walked **along** the queue with her notebook, raised her hand to greet each worker, and kept a **diary** of every **remark** she heard. She was **willing** to **evaluate** the evidence without defending her own idea. “**Regarding** the map,” one worker said, “you are asking the wrong people. Your notes record where the doors are, but not who cannot reach them.” The two problems were **equally** serious.

On Thursday a **drunken** man in a worn coat leaned **sideways** against the railing and exclaimed that the east gate had no ramp at all. He was not **resistant** to help; he was simply **accustomed** to being asked nothing. When Maya said **goodbye**, he added, **aloud**, that the queue needed a **suitable** ramp and that the **gossip** in the line was more **informative** than any official notice. She wrote it down. Anything else, she decided, would be guesswork, and anyway a survey that ignores a queue is not a survey. The form asked for age and sex before it asked whether the door opened.

The path to the east gate ran down a steep **slope** with a **geological** fault under the paving. It was **picturesque** in photographs and useless in rain. On **ceremonial** days the gate opened for guests; on ordinary days it awaited a guard. “**Liberty**,” Maya wrote in her **diary**, “is a door that opens without a ceremony.” Professor Zhao read the sentence and said that an original observation is worth more than a rate with three decimal places.

Lin was **inclined** to be **forgiving**. The mistake was **divisive** only if they hid it, and a **secretive** report would look **credible** while proving nothing. With **modesty**, they listed what they did not know. The **submissive** tone of the old notice, the **stuffy** room where it was written, and the **joyful** assumption that everything worked — all of it pointed **onward** to one **eventuality**: someone would be left outside, and their promise of change would never reach that person.

Maya wiped the whiteboard and turned it **outwards** so the corridor could read it. She was **fond** of the small map, but she was **impatient** with its silence, and she had thought about the missing voice until midnight. The work was not **rewarding** in the way a score is **rewarding**; it was **rewarding** because a stranger could now find the gate. Lin felt **contented** for the first time that month. “**Otherwise**,” Maya said, “we are only decorating a wall.”

中文翻译

一群上晚班的劳动者常常经过社团活动室却从不进来。显然他们有话要说，而林伟和曼雅都没有问过他们。曼雅拿着笔记本沿队伍走过去，举手向每位工人打招呼，把她听到的每句评论都记进日记。她愿意评估证据，而不是维护自己的想法。“关于这张地图，”一位工人说，“你们问错了人。你们的记录写着门在哪里，却没写谁走不到那里。”这两个问题同样严重。

周四，一个穿着旧外套的醉汉斜靠在栏杆上，大声说东门根本没有坡道。他并不抗拒帮助，只是习惯了没有人问他。曼雅道别时，他又出声补充：队伍需要一条合适的坡道，而且队伍里的闲话比任何官方通知都更有信息量。她把话记了下来。她认定，其他任何做法都只是猜测；无论如何，一份忽略排队的调查算不上调查。表格先问年龄和性别，之后才问门是否能打开。

通往东门的小路沿一段陡坡向下，铺路石下还有一条地质断层。它在照片里风景如画，在雨里却毫无用处。仪式日大门为来宾开放；平常日子它只等一名警卫。“自由，”曼雅在日记里写道，“是一扇不需要仪式就能打开的门。”赵教授读了这句话，说一段原创的观察比一个精确到小数点后三位的比例更有价值。

林伟倾向于宽容。这个错误只有在他们隐瞒时才会造成分裂，而一份偷偷摸摸的报告看起来可信，却什么也证明不了。他们带着谦逊，把不知道的部分也列了出来。旧通知里那种顺从的语气、写它时那间闷热的屋子、以及一切运转正常的快乐假设——所有这些都指向同一个可能：有人会被留在外面，而他们的承诺永远到不了那个人身上。

曼雅擦掉白板，把它转向外侧，好让走廊里的人都能看到。她喜欢这张小地图，却对它的沉默感到不耐烦；她一直想到午夜，想着那个缺席的声音。这份工作不像得分那样令人有回报感；它的回报在于陌生人现在能找到大门了。林伟那个第一次感到满足。“否则，”曼雅说，“我们只是在装饰一面墙。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
often 'ɒ:fn POS: adv	adv. 时常, 常常 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in many cases or instances
along ə'lon POS: adv	adv. 平行地, 向前; prep. 沿着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. with a forward motion; r. in accompaniment or as a companion; r. to a more advanced state; r. in addition (us...
obviously 'ɒbviesli POS: adv	adv. 显而易见地, 明显地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. unmistakably ('plain' is often used informally for 'plainly')
otherwise 'ʌðəwaɪz POS: adv	adv. 否则, 不同地, 别的方式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. other than as supposed or expected; r. in other respects or ways
willing 'wiliŋ POS: a	a. 乐意的, 自愿的, 甘愿的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. disposed or inclined toward
folk fəuk POS: n	n. 人们, 家人, 亲属, 民族; a. 民间的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people in general (often used in the plural)
equally 'i:kweɪli POS: adv	adv. 相等地, 同样地, 平等地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to the same degree (often followed by 'as')
suitable 'sju:təbl POS: a	a. 适当的, 相配的; [法] 合适的, 适宜的, 适当的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. meant or adapted for an occasion or use
neither 'naiðə POS: adv	adv. 皆不, 两个都不; a. (两者)都不的; pron. 两者都不; conj. 既非, 既不 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. not either; not one or the other
regarding ri'ga:diŋ POS: prep	prep. 关于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v deem to be; v look at attentively; v connect closely and often incriminatingly
evaluate 'i:væljueit POS: vt	vt. 评估, 评价, 赋值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. form a critical opinion of
remark ri'mɑ:k POS: n	n. 评论, 注意; vt. 评论, 注意; vi. 评论, 谈论; [计] 注释 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statement that expresses a personal opinion or belief or adds information; n. explicit notice
wipe waip POS: n	n. 擦拭, 用力打, 凸轮; vt. 擦, 揩, 消灭, 涂上, 拭去; vi. 擦, 打 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. rub with a circular motion
diary 'daieri POS: n	n. 日记; [经] 日记簿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a daily written record of (usually personal) experiences and observations; n. a personal journal (as a phys...
slope sləup POS: n	n. 倾斜, 斜坡, 斜率, 扛枪姿势; vt. 使倾斜, 弄斜, 扛; vi. 倾斜, 走, 逃走 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an elevated geological formation; v. be at an angle
await ə'weit POS: vt	vt. 等候; vi. 等待着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v look forward to the probable occurrence of
liberty 'libəli POS: n	n. 自由, 特权, 许可, 冒失; [法] 自由, 自由权, 自由区域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. freedom of choice; n. personal freedom from servitude or confinement or oppression
inclined in'klaɪnd POS: a	a. 倾向于...的, 想要...的, 可能的, 趋向于...的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (often followed by 'to') having a preference, disposition, or tendency; a. at an angle to the horizontal or...
fond fɒnd POS: a	a. 喜欢的, 宠爱的, 温柔的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (followed by 'of' or 'to') having a strong preference or liking for; s. absurd or silly because unlikely
exclaim iks'kleim POS: v	v. 大叫, 呼喊, 大声叫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. utter aloud; often with surprise, horror, or joy
goodbye gud'bai POS: review required	interj. 再见 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a farewell remark
aloud ə'laud POS: adv	adv. 出声地, 大声地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. using the voice; not silently
geological 'dʒiəu'lɒdʒikəl POS: a	a. 地质学的, 地质的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or based on geology

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
gossip 'gɒsɪp POS: n	n. 闲聊, 随笔, 流言, 爱讲闲话的人; vi. 说闲话, 闲聊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a report (often malicious) about the behavior of other people; n. a person given to gossiping and divulging...
accustomed ə'kʌstəmd POS: a	a. 惯常的, 习惯了的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (often followed by 'to') in the habit of or adapted to; s. commonly used or practiced; usual
sideways 'saɪdweɪz POS: adv	adv. 向旁边, 向侧面地; a. 旁边的, 向侧面的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. with one side forward or to the front; r. toward one side
resistant rɪ'zɪstənt POS: n	n. 抵抗者, 反抗者; a. 抵抗的, 反抗的, 耐...的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. impervious to being affected
impatient ɪm'peɪjənt POS: a	a. 不耐烦的, 着急的, 急切的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. restless or short-tempered under delay or opposition; s. (usually followed by 'to') full of eagerness
drunken 'drʌŋkən POS: a	a. 酒醉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s given to or marked by the consumption of alcohol
picturesque 'pɪktʃə'resk POS: a	a. 生动的, 如画的, 独特的, 别致的, 栩栩如生的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. suggesting or suitable for a picture; pretty as a picture; s. strikingly expressive
rewarding rɪ'wɔ:dlɪŋ POS: a	a. 有益的, 有报酬的, 报答的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. providing personal satisfaction
outwards 'aʊtwədz POS: adv	adv. 向外地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r toward the outside
informative ɪn'fɔ:mətɪv POS: a	a. 提供消息的, 见闻广博的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. providing or conveying information
ceremonial 'serɪ'məunjəl POS: n	n. 仪式; a. 正式的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by pomp or ceremony or formality
divisive dɪ'vaɪsɪv POS: a	a. 区分的, 制造分裂的, 造成不和的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s dissenting (especially dissenting with the majority opinion)
forgiving fə'gɪvɪŋ POS: a	a. 宽大的, 容许有错误的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. inclined or able to forgive and show mercy
modesty 'mɒdɪstɪ POS: n	n. 谦逊, 质朴, 羞怯 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. freedom from vanity or conceit; n. formality and propriety of manner
joyful 'dʒɔɪfʊl POS: a	a. 欢喜的, 高兴的, 令人高兴的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of or producing joy
secretive sɪ'kri:tɪv POS: a	a. 秘密的, 偷偷摸摸的, 分泌的, 促进分泌的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s inclined to secrecy or reticence about divulging information
onward 'ɒnwəd POS: a	a. 向前的, 前进的; adv. 向前, 前进, 在先 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r forward in time or order or degree; r in a forward direction
eventuality ɪ'ventʃu'æliɪti POS: n	n. 可能发生的事, 可能性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a possible event or occurrence or result
contented kən'tentɪd POS: a	a. 满足的, 心安的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. satisfied or showing satisfaction with things as they are
stuffy 'stʌfi POS: a	a. 闷热的, 窒息的, 乏味的, 固步自封的, 自以为是的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. affected with a sensation of stoppage or obstruction
submissive səb'mɪsɪv POS: a	a. 服从的, 顺从的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. inclined or willing to submit to orders or wishes of others or showing such inclination
creditable 'kredɪtəbl POS: a	a. 可称誉的, 声誉好的, 可信的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. worthy of often limited commendation